



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Beatrice Mayes Institute

School Website: <https://bmischool.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Overall classification: CLASSICAL School: Austin Classical School (austinclassical.org) Bottom line: Austin Classical School explicitly grounds its mission and model in Christian classical education. Its public materials repeatedly invoke truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom and virtue; the Trivium; Great Books; Latin; Socratic discussion; memory work; and a collaborative partnership with parents. The only area with less direct evidence is Faculty formation language (e.g., “portrait of a teacher,” “living curriculum”). Nonetheless, the school’s faculty claims and practices still align broadly with classical aims. URL for this audit: <https://austinclassical.org/>

— Overall rating: CLASSICAL

Full Classicality Audit**CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS**

1) Keywords found in school materials (verbatim/near□verbatim):

- “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty” (page title and body); “cultivate wisdom and virtue” (aim); “Trivium,” “great books,” “great conversation,” “integrated curriculum,” “idea□focused instruction”
- “under the sovereignty of God through theology” (integration statement)
- Christ□centered mission: “exists to glorify Jesus Christ” (mission) ; “Christ□centered/Christ□infused” and Statement of Faith linked in FAQs
- Scripture/Theology woven into studies: Bible centrality; “Exegesis & Hermeneutics,” “Applied Exegesis,” “Apologetics & Ethics,” “Development of Christian Doctrine & Church History” in the Upper School sequence
- Liturgical/communal notes: school□wide choir; “songs, chants, and rhymes” in grammar grades

2) Mapping vs. the Six Elements lexicon:

- Positive indicators matched: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; wisdom; theology; Scripture; apologetics; exegesis; Christ□centered; reverence (implied in worshipful tone and choir)
- Negative indicators: none observed (no values□neutral language, relativism, etc.)

3) Quantification:

- Positive keyword hits: 13
- Negative keyword hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage of sub□criteria (moral realism, theology, liturgy/communal worship): 0.80 (strong on moral realism and theology; partial on explicit liturgy/chapel references)

4) Category rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

1) Keywords found:

- Aim: “To cultivate wisdom and virtue...” and to contemplate the “True, the Good, and the Beautiful”

- Telos and formation: “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose”
- 2) Mapping vs. lexicon:
- Positive: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of the true, good, beautiful; formation over information; eternal telos
 - Negative: no “college and career readiness” or 21st-century skills framing observed
- 3) Quantification:
- Positive hits: 10
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage (virtue/wisdom; transcendental moral realism; formation): 0.95
- 4) Category rating: CLASSICAL
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CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

- 1) Keywords found:
- Trivium: “Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric,” with detailed grade-band descriptions; “Senior Thesis” in Rhetoric stage
 - Latin: Latin from 5th grade; formal logic (8th); rhetoric instruction (10th)
 - Great Books/Great Conversation: explicitly named as a guiding idea of the curriculum
 - History, not “social studies,” is sequenced (Ancient, Medieval & Renaissance, U.S./Global context)
 - Theology integrated: “under the sovereignty of God through theology”; Bible central place in the great conversation; robust Christian Studies sequence
- 2) Mapping vs. lexicon:
- Positive: Trivium; Latin; logic; rhetoric; Great Books; primary texts; integrated knowledge; wonder-oriented language (curiosity, delight)
 - Negative: no STEM-first or project-dominant framing; no “social studies” label observed
- 3) Quantification:
- Positive hits: 14
 - Negative hits: 0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage (Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books; integration; wonder): 0.95 (Trivium/Great Books/integration are explicit; Quadrivium elements implied via math/music but not named exhaustively)
- 4) Category rating: CLASSICAL
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CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

- 1) Keywords found:
- Grammar stage: “memorization, recitation, and songs”
 - Logic stage: “debate and discussion”
 - Socratic: “we employ the Socratic method in our classrooms”
 - Rhetoric: persuasion, imitation of models, thesis defense, eloquent oral/written communication
 - Restful/wonder: “at leisure to study and to play”; “joyful, life-long learning” (scholé-adjacent)
- 2) Mapping vs. lexicon:

- Positive: chanting/singing/memory work; debate/discussion; Socratic seminar/dialectic; rhetoric/orations/thesis; restfulness/leisure and wonder language
- Negative: word “efficiency” appears in the collaborative □ schedule explanation (a mild counter □ signal to restfulness)

3) Quantification:

- Positive hits: 12
- Negative hits: 1 (“efficiency”)
- Percent positive: 0.92
- Coverage (memory/chant; Socratic; rhetoric/oration; restfulness): 0.95

4) Category rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

1) Keywords found:

- “qualified, Christian educators,” office hours on homeschool days to support families; teachers provide weekly lesson plans; heavy teacher–parent mentoring dynamic in collaborative model
- Head of School invites families to “experience... faculty, staff, and students” in action; mission emphasizes cultivating virtue/wisdom under Christ

2) Mapping vs. lexicon:

- Positive (partial): teacher as mentor/guide implied by collaborative co □ teaching; moral/Christian orientation clear. Less explicit: “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty of friends,” “living curriculum”
- Negative: none observed.

3) Quantification:

- Positive hits: 4
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage (models/mentors; collegiality; portrait of teacher): 0.50 (implied mentoring and collaboration; missing explicit “portrait” language)

4) Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

1) Keywords found:

- Mission: “co □ laboring with families”
- Collaborative model: parents as “co □ teacher parents,” weekly plans; office hours on homeschool days; training for co □ teachers; tours and information meetings
- Community culture and formation emphasis, including house system (e.g., “House of Hildegard” in Upper School life)

2) Mapping vs. lexicon:

- Positive: parental partnership/co □ educators; parent formation/training; open visits/tours; intentional community
- Negative: no consumer language; high parental integration is explicit.

3) Quantification:

- Positive hits: 8

- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage (partnership; parent formation; welcome/open campus): 1.00

4) Category rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Assessment

- Category ratings: [Religious/Metaphysical: CLASSICAL] [Purpose/Goal: CLASSICAL] [Curriculum: CLASSICAL] [Pedagogy: CLASSICAL] [Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL] [Parents/Community: CLASSICAL]
- Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Because only the Faculty category fell short of explicit classical language (though practices appear sound), the overall judgment remains CLASSICAL.

If needed: What would move the needle (Faculty) - Publish a concise “Portrait of a Teacher” and “Portrait of a Graduate” framing teachers as model tutors/mentors and “living curriculum” (virtue, wisdom, lifelong learning). Use explicit classical lexicon (e.g., “moral imagination,” “intellectual virtue,” “faculty of friends”). This would likely move Faculty from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.

Sources (inline)

Key quotations and claims are drawn from Austin Classical School’s website pages, including Classical Education Basics, curriculum outlines, collaborative model, Head of School message, and admissions/tours pages, as cited throughout:

The keyword framework and positive/negative indicators are from the Six Essential Elements/lexicon documents used for evaluation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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